

FATHER SOLANUS NOTEBOOK NO. 2

Pg. 47
cont.

send His angels, and they shall gather out of His kingdom all scandals, and them that work iniquity. And shall cast them into the furnace of fire; there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth. "Then shall the just shine as the sun in the kingdom of their Father. - He that hath ears to hear, let him hear." But alas, dear Br. in our daily wrestling for an existence, aye even as Sunday after Sunday we arise here at the reading of the holy Gospel or sit down to listen to the word of God, we little realize what is in truth the gravity of our situation. We little realize the spiritual dangers that surround us. We little realize the pernicious presence of the cockle that flourishes on every side, the cockle of scandal in so many ways: the cockle of bad example, the cockle of irreligion, of schism, of heresy, of implied and open atheism: The cockle of indifferentism and lukewarmness in God's service of those who profess to be Catholics and are but withered branches. The general craze among all classes for pleasure and amusement - very often sinful in itself - craze for the dance hall, the moving picture, the gambling hall, the ball room. Then the sources of scandal of which our Holy Father Pope Benedict XV complains of in his encyclical to the warring nations (1) lack of mutual love among men, (2) disregard for authority, (3) unjust quarrels among the different classes, (4) material prosperity becoming the absorbing object of (see below *)

Pg. 48

(8th Sunday P. Pentecost, 1917 10 1/4 M.C.
"Give an account of Thy Stewardship." Luke XV 2
One lamentable source of evil among men is the fact that people think so little about the "one thing necessary. More truly now than in the days of the Prophet Jerim. might his words of lamentation be applied to human society. "With desolation is all the world made desolate, because there is no one that considereth in the heart.)

* Human endeavor as though there were nothing higher and better to be gained." Indeed we little realize the gravity of our situation because it is impossible for us to appreciate the almost infinite -